# MICHAEL SIMBA

**GROWTH | STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIPS | MARKETING**

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## PROFILE

Marketing and partnerships leader with 9+ years across fintech, payments, technology and consumer brands. Experienced in building commercial relationships, developing campaigns that make partner value clear, and connecting marketing activity to acquisition and business growth. Built partner pipelines from zero, secured institutional relationships with MoneyGram and Choice Bank, and worked across sales, product and leadership teams to bring complex products to market in Africa and internationally.

## CORE EXPERTISE

**Partnerships** Partner strategy and sourcing • Commercial negotiations • Partner enablement • Ecosystem development • Co marketing

**Marketing** Integrated campaigns • Product positioning • Content and events • Launch communications • Demand generation

**Operations** CRM and pipeline management • Campaign reporting • Budget planning • Cross functional delivery • AI assisted workflows

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

### Head of Growth & Marketing | Helicode

Mar 2026 to Present

- Lead go to market strategy, marketing and commercial partnership development for a payroll and compliance platform serving businesses with teams across African markets.
- Shape joint value propositions, partner proposals, campaign messaging and sales materials with founders, product and operations teams; develop ecosystem opportunities across payment and workforce platforms.
- Create founder content, product education, partner announcements and direct outreach campaigns, using customer feedback and pipeline signals to refine priorities and messaging.
- Supported early commercial growth as Helicode reached more than 100 business customers and reported a tenfold increase in payroll volume during a key operating period.

### Communications & Partnerships Manager | NedaPay

Jan 2025 to Present

- Lead product communications and partnership messaging for a payments platform serving merchants, freelancers and businesses across African markets.
- Develop partner briefs, launch materials, product narratives and digital campaigns that make payment infrastructure and local currency use cases understandable to prospective users and partners.
- Coordinate with founders, product and creative teams on consistent messaging and campaign execution across Tanzania, Kenya, Ghana, Malawi and Nigeria.

### Growth, Partnerships & Marketing Lead | Sents Bank

Aug 2022 to Feb 2026

- Built a commercial and distribution partnership pipeline from the ground up, sourcing and onboarding more than 12 partners across East Africa.
- Sourced, negotiated and closed Choice Bank as an institutional partner through outbound business development in under one month, then coordinated partner onboarding and internal delivery.
- Led integrated acquisition and brand campaigns across business and consumer audiences, delivering a 40%+ lift in unaided brand awareness and 60% growth in social and community audience over 18 months.
- Introduced weekly tracking of campaign performance, partnership opportunities and marketing spend, reducing wasted advertising spend by approximately 30% and reporting results directly to the CEO.
- Managed a cross functional growth team and worked with product, engineering and customer service to align commercial campaigns, partner requirements and customer experience.

### Business Development, Partnerships & Communications | HoneyCoin

2021 to 2024

- Secured MoneyGram as a strategic integration partner through outbound business development in eight weeks, managing the commercial process and onboarding coordination.
- Produced partner pitch materials, launch messaging, executive communications and external campaigns supporting relationships with payment and ecosystem partners, including PayPal and Safaricom.
- Led communications and public relations activity across African and United States markets, contributing to more than 200 media placements for product and company initiatives.
- Coordinated creator, community and media campaigns, including the Octopizzo NFT launch and live social programming, connecting stakeholders and creative partners through delivery.

### Partnerships & Product Manager | Swypt.io

Jan 2025 to Sep 2025

- Planned the Future Payments, Today merchant event, coordinating campaign content, external partners and event requirements against a KES 800,000 working budget and a target audience of 500.
- Coordinated teams of 12 or more across product, finance and compliance, introducing operational improvements that reduced process inefficiencies by 23%.

### Marketing & Communications Manager | Artcaffé

2019 to 2021

- Managed integrated marketing campaigns, brand content, partnerships and customer communications; coordinated designers, production suppliers and internal stakeholders.

### Creative Producer | Switch Media Kenya

2021

- Produced audience focused editorial and creative content, managing contributors, production schedules and deliverables.

## EDUCATION

**University of Pretoria** B.F.A. Journalism, 2023

**Africa Digital Media Institute** Diploma, Digital Communication & Multimedia, 2021

**Professional development** Project Management Professional (PMP), in progress

## TOOLS & WORKING STYLE

HubSpot • Google Analytics • LinkedIn Campaign Manager • Meta Ads Manager • Airtable • Notion • Google Workspace • Slack • Figma • AI tools for research, drafting, analysis and quality review